

Anand Mathew

PhD Candidate in Economics
University of Florida

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA, PhD in Economics	2022 – May 2027 (expected)
Advisor: Ignacia Mercadal	
SOUTH ASIAN UNIVERSITY, New Delhi, Master of Economics (Development Economics)	2020
ST. STEPHEN'S COLLEGE, University of Delhi, BA (Hons) in Economics	2018

FIELDS

Primary: Development Economics, Household Finance
Secondary: Environmental Economics, Applied Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Credit Where Credit Is Withdrawn: Weather Shocks and the Household Coping Portfolio in India
with Sankalp Mathur (CAFRAL)

Weather shocks cut income in India, and household consumption barely moves. The null has been found often enough to look like a fact about insurance. We argue it is a fact about the outcome variable. Total spending does not respond because households change what they buy rather than how much, and a regression on the level looks for a change in scale that never occurs. In a panel of 210,942 Indian households observed from 2014 to 2019 and matched to 1.08 billion loan records from the credit bureau, spending cuts begin with the postponable, from entertainment and restaurant meals down through clothing, and stop before cereals, which do not fall at all. The September 2018 default of Infrastructure Leasing and Financial Services, a funding shock that bound hardest in districts reliant on non-bank lenders, then lets us ask what formal credit contributes. Where the lender withdrew, the same weather shock pushes households further along the ordering, into health, education, and staples such as milk, none of which move where credit held. Displaced borrowers mostly do not resurface at moneylenders. More stop borrowing altogether than switch, so losing formal access looks closer to rationing than redirection. Availability of credit does not stop a weather shock from being felt. It determines how far down the coping portfolio a household has to go.

WORKING PAPERS

Cannabis Access and College Persistence: Evidence from Washington State's Dispensary Lottery

Using Washington State's lottery for recreational cannabis retail licenses and a staggered difference-in-differences design, I find that colleges within a 10-minute drive of a dispensary saw first-year retention fall by 7.9 percentage points. Enrollment did not change.

PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association, 96th Annual Meeting, Houston (scheduled)	Nov 2026
World Inequality Conference, Paris School of Economics	Jun 2026
Southern Economic Association, 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa	Nov 2025
WATE-Florida Workshop	Oct 2025
Discussant	
WATE-Florida Workshop, "Student Debt and Aggregate Consumption"	Oct 2025

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Madelyn Lockhart Doctoral Student Travel Award, University of Florida (three awards)	2025, 2026
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of Florida	
ECO 4421 Econometrics (undergraduate)	Fall 2025, Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant, University of Florida	
Econometrics and Data Analysis (undergraduate and graduate)	2024 – 2026
Game Theory and Industrial Organization (undergraduate and graduate)	2022 – 2024
Public Economics, Managerial Economics, Macroeconomics, Microeconomics	2023 – 2026

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Douglas Turner, University of Florida	Summer 2026
Research Assistant to Scott Kostyshak, University of Florida	Spring 2024
Research Assistant to Gunnar Heins and Ignacia Mercadal, University of Florida	Summer 2023
Research Assistant, Schumacher Centre Society, New Delhi	2020 – 2022
Research Intern, DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India	2019 – 2020
Survey Coordinator, National Food Security Act survey led by Jean Drèze and Reetika Khera	2016

SOFTWARE AND LANGUAGES

Software: R, Stata, Snowflake Cortex AI, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Google Maps geocoding and distance APIs
Languages: English, Hindi

REFERENCES

Ignacia Mercadal (Advisor) Assistant Professor of Economics University of Florida imercadal@ufl.edu	Sankalp Mathur Assistant Professor CAFRAL, Mumbai sankalp.mathur@cafral.org.in	Douglas Turner Assistant Professor of Economics University of Florida douglasturner@ufl.edu
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